



Capstone Discovery + PRD-Light

Week 8 • Day 2 • AI Spec Development & Capstone

TPM Academy



Day 2 Objectives

- Run **compressed customer discovery** in 35 minutes
- Name the **persona / Jobs To Be Done (JTBD) / pain points** for Holocron
- Draft the compressed **Product Requirements Document (PRD-light) Sections 1–7** — 2 pages, full discipline
- Apply the **compression discipline**: cut what's cosmetic; keep what's load-bearing
- Validate with AI; plan tomorrow's compressed architecture work



Today's Shape

Clock	Block	Outcome
09:00 – 09:15	Opening	Inputs gathered overnight; pin discovery summary plan
09:15 – 10:30	Block 1 + Activity 1	Compressed customer discovery
10:45 – 12:00	Block 2 + Activity 2	PRD-light Sections 1–4
13:00 – 14:15	Block 3 + Activity 3	PRD-light Sections 5–7
14:30 – 16:00	Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap	AI validation + Day-3 setup

Block 1 — Compressed Discovery

Week-1 muscles in 45 minutes



The Compression Discipline

Compressed work is **not** lower-quality work. It's **selective**: keep what's load-bearing, cut what's cosmetic.

- Section 1 Context (½ page)
- Section 2 Problem (½ page)
- Section 3 Goals + non-goals (½ page)
- Section 4 Scope (in/out table)
- Section 5 Solution sketch (½ page)
- Section 6 Top 6–8 acceptance criteria (ACs)
- Section 7 Top 5 non-functional requirements (NFRs), one per category

2 pages total. Every word earns its place.



Ground in Customer Signal

Pool your discovery into three buckets — start from the **Discovery Signal Pack**, then add what you confirm firsthand with the real stakeholders.

Bucket	What goes here
Direct signal	Interviews, support tickets, observation, usage data
Indirect signal	Public reviews, competitor analysis, internal Slack
What's missing	Be honest — the open questions to confirm with stakeholders

Do not invent customer signal — ground every claim in the pack or a source you confirm.



Compressed Persona

```
**Persona:** <role + segment>  
**Job-to-be-done:** <verb-based, in their language>  
**Why it's hard today:** <specific friction; quote a real customer  
if possible>
```

Worked example:

"Persona: New B2B finance ops associate at a 200-person company.
JTBD: Close the books each month without staying late on Friday. Why
hard: 'I spend Thursday night chasing 4 different teams for missing
accruals — by the time they respond, I've forgotten what I asked.'"

Activity 1 — Compressed Discovery

Quads • 45 minutes

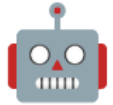
- 20 min: synthesize gathered inputs
- 10 min: name persona / JTBD / why hard
- 10 min: top 3 pains scored on severity / frequency / addressability
- 5 min: sanity check — does this sound like a real customer?



20 + 10 + 10 + 5

Block 2 — PRD-Light Sections 1–4

Context, Problem, Goals/Non-goals, Scope



AI Assistance Pattern

Quad members **solo-draft first**. Pick the strongest. **Then** apply AI to tighten.

```
Role: Editor for a TPM's PRD context section.  
Context: <quad's draft Section 1 + discovery summary>  
Task: Tighten this section to ½ page max. Preserve the  
customer quote. Preserve the strategic anchor. Cut anything  
that sounds like marketing language.  
Constraints:  
- Do not invent customer signal  
- Flag any claim that needs source backing  
Format: Tightened Section 1 + a "what I cut" note.
```

Activity 2 — PRD-Light Sections 1–4

Quads • 50 minutes

- 25 min: Section 1 + Section 2 (solo drafts → quad picks → AI tightens)
- 15 min: Section 3 goals + non-goals
- 10 min: Section 4 scope (in/out table)



25 + 15 + 10

Block 3 — PRD-Light Sections 5–7

Solution sketch, AC, NFRs



AC Coverage (Compressed)

Path	Count
Happy	3
Sad	2
Weird	1

Compressed = **fewer ACs**, not weaker ACs. Use Given/When/Then. Same 5-failure-mode discipline.



NFR Coverage (Compressed)

- 1 **Performance** NFR (latency target with defense)
- 1 **Security** NFR (auth/authz)
- 1 **Accessibility** NFR (Web Content Accessibility Guidelines, WCAG floor)
- 1 **Observability** NFR (the leading indicator)
- 1 **Compliance** NFR (the regime that applies)

Each uses the **requirement / defense / verification** template. Defense is non-optional.

Activity 3 — PRD-Light Sections 5–7

Quads • 50 minutes

- 10 min: Section 5 solution sketch (no implementation)
- 25 min: Section 6 ACs (3 happy / 2 sad / 1 weird)
- 15 min: Section 7 NFRs (5 categories, one each)



10 + 25 + 15

Block 4 — AI Validation + Day-3 Plan

Catch the issues; set up tomorrow's architecture

PRD-Light Validation Prompt

Role: Senior PM reviewing a compressed PRD.

Context: <paste PRD-light Sections 1-7>

Task: Identify 5 issues:

1. A claim that lacks evidence
2. A goal that's actually an output
3. A non-goal that's missing
4. An AC that's untestable or vague
5. An NFR that's boilerplate

Constraints:

- Be specific
- Suggest a concrete fix

Format: 5 numbered findings.



Day-3 Setup

Plan ahead before leaving today:

1. **3 architectural questions** a senior architect would ask reading PRD-light
2. **Integration map sketch** — systems / data / APIs in scope
3. **Critical path** — what must ship by EOD tomorrow vs Thursday?

Activity 4 — Validation + Day-3 Plan

Quads • 55 minutes • Wrap

- 15 min: AI validation pass (adopt / defer / reject)
- 10 min: update PRD-light + provenance log
- 30 min: Day-3 plan (3 architecture questions, integration sketch, critical path)



15 + 10 + 30 • 15-min wrap



Day 2 Wrap

What we built

- Discovery summary (1 page)
- PRD-light Sections 1–7 (2 pages)
- AI validation pass
- Day-3 plan

What opens tomorrow

- **Capstone architecture + AI Spec drafted**
- Technical Concept Document (TCD-light) + Technical Modeling Document (TMD-light)
- 5-prompt sequence on the capstone

Bring to Day 3: PRD-light + Day-3 plan. Tomorrow we go architectural.

Questions & Reflection

What was hardest about compressing your PRD work today?